family. A mob of common people had gathered at the gate by dawn and hullabaloo was turning more and more intense. One of the men conveyed the message and said, ‘Unless Babur comes himself, there will be no holding these people in.’ Hearing the news, Babur reached to control the situation. Perhaps deliberations of talk would have sorted the situation, but Babur chose a harsher path. He got more than a couple of people shot and some others chopped into pieces. Commoners were rattled with fear. They let Muqīm and his family get out safe and sound.

To conclude, it was sometime in October of AD 1504 that it happened. Babur has mentioned it in the *Baburnama*:

> It was in the last ten days of the Second Rabī’ that without a fight, without an effort, by Almighty God’s bounty and mercy, I obtained and made subject to me Kābul and Ghaznī and their dependent districts.

Kābul in Babur’s Eyes[6]

The country (as addressed by Babur in the *Baburnama*) of Kābul was situated in the Fourth climate (Babur calls places of colder climate by this term) amid the cultivated lands. Lamghānāt, Parashāwar (Peshāwar), Hash(t)-Nagar and some of the countries of Hindustan lied to the east of Kābul. The mountain region in west had Karnūd and Ghūr, which Babur mentions to be the refuge and dwelling-places of the Hazāra and Nikdīrī tribes. The ranges of Hindū-kush on the north separated the countries of Qūndūz and Andar-āb. On the south to Kābul lay Afghānistān, Bannū, Farmūl and Naghr.

a. Town and environs of Kābul

   The district of Kābul has small extent with greatest length from east to west and is wrapped around by mountains. The walled towns of Kābul is connected by those Mountains and one at the lower heights is known as Shāh-of-Kābul as once upon a time, a (Hindū) Shāh of Kābul had built a abode on its summit. Shāh-of-Kābul starts and ends at the Dūrrīn narrows and Dih-i-yaq‘ūb respectively. It has a perimeter of around 4 miles and its foothills are covered with gardens fed from a canal which was brought along it by Wais Atāka, Aūlūgh Beg Mīrzā’s (Babur’s paternal uncle) guardian. The canal ends in corner quarter known as Kul-kīna. It was said in Babur’s time that the place had seen a lots of debauchery. Babur mentions in the *Baburnama* that sometimes people defined this place using